

PHOTOGRAPHY IS STILL AN ART

It's just a changing art form, and cannot stay what it was decades ago

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Any activity that results in something that evokes emotions in viewer can be considered art. Photography invoke emotions in the viewer. It really is that simple. How good a photo looks in terms of clarity, is not what makes a photograph a piece of art. Rather, it's the composition of the photograph (lighting, composition etc), the amount of thought and effort put into taking that perfect shot etc., that make up the characteristics that define good artwork. Just because you can do it from a smartphone doesn't mean photography is no longer art.

One of the main things tech innovation does is to make a task easier to do, and that's all technology has done for photography. Remember the analog days when photography was a time consuming and expensive hobby, exclusive to the rich or professionals? When you couldn't immediately see the results of the shoot, but had to spend hours developing it in a lightroom? All that changed when technology introduced us to digital photography. It levelled the playing field and brought photography to the masses.

Technology is constantly improving the quality of photography and cameras, and I'm going to walk you through some of these developments.

MODERN PHOTOGRAPHY

It has never been easier for someone to get started with photography. There are countless resources for photography online that teach photography. Forums to clear all your queries are a tap away. In fact, many of the mainstream photographers were self-made. Take Ana Bathe, the unconventional portraiture photographer for example; she was rejected by all the photography schools she had applied to and taught herself photography through online videos. The internet has also made it easier for photographers to showcase their work. Services like Patreon, 500px and deviantart have given photographers the ability to upload their content online and even monetize them. If anything, technology is helping the photography art form thrive and grow.

DSLR SALES DOESN'T AFFECT PHOTOGRAPHY

There's no denying that DSLR sales have dropped drastically since the advent of the smartphone. However, this does not directly equate to the death of photography as an art form. Photography has always served two purposes, documentation and creative photography. By documentation, I mean, taking photos purely for recording a moment. A large section of the population bought DSLRs for documentation purely because of it's superior quality. With the improvement of smartphone cameras, that need just went away. However, they weren't the "Artists" in the first place, so using a drop in sales to them doesn't prop up the argument that the art form is dying. A similar trend can be seen in the sale of PCs. The overall number of PCs sold is decreasing at an alarming rate. But can you equate that to coding dying out? Obviously not, because we seem to have coders coming out of our ears these days!